

Friday, 10 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 23°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 35° 21°	MANCHESTER Overcast 34° 19°	GLASGOW Overcast 28° 17°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Much of England remains under amber heat health alerts as the country breaks the record for the most 34-degree days in a year.

This means health services and travel are likely to be disrupted. With temperatures continuing to soar, people are urged to stay hydrated and take precautions.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

The family of 14-year-old Lilly Jones, found stabbed in woodlands, have described her as 'beautiful, kind and caring'.

Lilly's loved ones said she was "completely and utterly herself" and had an "eclectic taste in music". Police are continuing their investigation into her death.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Prince Harry has put his UK trip back on track with a visit to a children's hospital in Birmingham.

The Duke of Sussex's visit follows a somewhat bumpy start to his return to the UK. He spent time meeting young patients and staff.

ROYALS · UK
- 4

The Prime Minister has hinted at a potential bank holiday if England win the World Cup.

Sir Keir Starmer said he didn't want to "jinx it" but suggested he would consider it if England reached the final. It's certainly a talking point for fans across the country.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

A replica of a mosque displayed on a bonfire has been condemned as 'anti-Muslim hatred'.

The bonfire in Moygashel has previously featured other controversial banners. This latest display has sparked widespread criticism.

COMMUNITY · UK

What's coming up

1

Love Island winner Cach Mercer is joining the star-studded line-up for Strictly Come Dancing!

Cach, who is also a model and DJ, is an ambassador for a mental health charity. He'll be hoping to samba his way to success on the dancefloor.

ON AIR – Do you think reality TV stars make good Strictly contestants?

TV · COMING UP

2

Justin Bieber is set to join Madonna, Shakira, and BTS for the FIFA World Cup final half-time show!

This Super Bowl-style performance marks Bieber's latest big comeback show after his appearances at Coachella. It promises to be a spectacular event.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see perform at a major sporting event?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3

Tom Holland has described his role in Christopher Nolan's hotly anticipated movie The Odyssey as 'a real pinch-me moment'.

The Spider-Man star and other cast members have been sharing their excitement about the upcoming film. It's expected to be a huge cinematic event.

ON AIR – What's the most anticipated film release you're looking forward to?

FILM · COMING UP

4

The Pitt is leading the race for this year's Emmy Awards, but Stranger Things has been snubbed in the top categories.

The Pitt and Hacks are currently ahead in the nominations for America's most coveted TV awards. Fans are eagerly awaiting the results.

ON AIR – Are there any shows you think were unfairly snubbed in the Emmy nominations?

TV · COMING UP

5

Pontypridd, Birkenhead, and the Isle of Bute are among the shortlisted locations for the first ever UK Town of Culture!

Basildon, Grimsby, and Rotherham also made the 15-strong list, alongside Strabane. It's a fantastic opportunity for these towns to showcase their cultural offerings.

ON AIR – Which town do you think deserves to be crowned the first UK Town of Culture?

CULTURE · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Karolina Muchova has beaten Coco Gauff in an epic tie-break to reach the Wimbledon final!**
 Muchova recovered from match point down in a thrilling deciding-set tie-break on Centre Court. She will now face Noskova in the final.
ON AIR – That was an incredible match! Who are you backing for the women's final now?
 TENNIS · UK
- 2 Wimbledon has witnessed some extraordinary days on Centre Court, but British wildcard Arthur Fery reaching the semi-finals is among the very best.**
 Fery has defied the odds with his incredible run in the tournament. He's captured the imagination of fans across the country.
ON AIR – What a story Arthur Fery is! Have you been following his incredible journey at Wimbledon?
 TENNIS · UK
- 3 England defender Jarell Quansah has received a two-match ban after his red card against Mexico.**
 This means Quansah will miss England's upcoming matches. It's a blow for the team as they continue their World Cup campaign.
ON AIR – How big a loss will Quansah be for England in the next two games?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Tadej Pogacar has dominated on the Tourmalet, taking a big step towards winning the Tour de France!**
 He regained the yellow jersey with a dominant victory on stage six. Pogacar is now aiming for a record-equalling fifth Tour de France title.
ON AIR – Pogacar is on fire! Can anyone stop him from making history at the Tour de France?
 CYCLING · GLOBAL
- 5 Louis Rees-Zammit has been dropped to the bench as Wales make changes for their match against Argentina.**
 Sam Costelow will start at number 10 as Wales make three changes to the starting line-up. It's a bold move ahead of a crucial game.
ON AIR – What do you make of Louis Rees-Zammit being benched for this important match?
 RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that listening to the gentle rumble of a washing machine can be surprisingly calming.**
It seems the steady, rhythmic hum provides a soothing backdrop for many, akin to white noise, helping to reduce stress and even aid concentration for some.
- 2 The simple joy of 'doodling during phone calls' is making a quiet comeback.**
Research indicates that these spontaneous scribbles can actually help improve focus and memory during conversations, rather than being a distraction.
- 3 A delightful trend for 'vintage-style picnic baskets' is encouraging more outdoor eating.**
People are rediscovering the charm of packing a proper picnic, complete with checked blankets and traditional fare, for outings in parks and countryside.
- 4 The comforting appeal of 'collecting old Ordnance Survey maps' is seeing a gentle resurgence.**
Many are finding pleasure in tracing routes, remembering past holidays, and appreciating the detailed cartography of these historic guides.
- 5 Interest in 'identifying garden birds by their song' is growing among nature enthusiasts.**
Apps and guides are making it easier for people to distinguish between the chirps and trills, adding another layer of enjoyment to garden wildlife spotting.
- 6 A charming trend for 'decorating garden sheds' is turning them into mini-havens.**
Forget drab storage; these sheds are being transformed into cosy retreats, art studios, or even miniature pubs, complete with fairy lights and comfy chairs.
- 7 The humble 'tea towel' is being celebrated as a surprisingly versatile household item beyond drying dishes.**
From impromptu placemats to wrapping warm bread, its usefulness is being rediscovered in various creative and practical ways around the home.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with their remote control when the batteries are running low, even though they know it doesn't really work?

ANSWER: SHAKING IT VIGOROUSLY, OR TAPPING IT AGAINST THE PALM OF THEIR HAND.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'route' they absolutely have to take when walking around their local supermarket, even if it means extra steps?

ANSWER: A VERY SPECIFIC PATH THROUGH THE AISLES, REGARDLESS OF WHERE THE ITEMS ARE ON THEIR LIST.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old board game' from your childhood, and it's surprisingly fun to play again?**

What's that one classic board game you've pulled out recently that brought back a flood of memories and was unexpectedly entertaining?

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do to make a cup of tea or coffee absolutely perfect, don't we?**

What's your essential, non-negotiable step in preparing your favourite hot drink? Is it a specific mug, a particular stirring technique, or something else entirely?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of magpies is called a 'chatter'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar, weighing less than a penny.
- The Great Barrier Reef off the coast of Australia is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from space.
- The inventor of the Pringle chip can, Fredric Baur, had his ashes buried in one when he passed away.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar sources.
- The quietest room in the world, an anechoic chamber at Microsoft's headquarters, is so silent you can hear your own heartbeat.
- The first successful photograph of a human being was taken in 1838 by Louis Daguerre, though the person was simply having their shoes polished.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn, a mythical creature symbolising purity and innocence.

On this day

Day 191 of the year, 174 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Mauritania); Christian feast day: Amalberga of Maubeuge; Christian feast day: Canute IV of Denmark; Christian feast day: Martyrs of Damascus. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Chiwetel Ejiofor, English actor
- 1949 — Greg Kihn, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2024)
- 1976 — Elijah Blue Allman, American singer and guitarist
- 1972 — Sofía Vergara, Colombian-American actress and producer
- 1942 — Ronnie James Dio, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2010)
- 1967 — Rebekah Del Rio, American singer-songwriter (died 2025)
- 1943 — Jerry Miller, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2024)
- 2001 — Isabela Merced, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Erden Eruç begins the first solo human-powered circumnavigation of the world.
- 1991 — A Beechcraft Model 99 crashes near Birmingham Municipal Airport (now Birmingham-Shuttlesworth International Airport) in Birmingham, Alabama, killing 13 of the 15 people on board.
- 1997 — Miguel Ángel Blanco, a member of Partido Popular (Spain), is kidnapped (and later murdered) in the Basque city of Ermua by ETA members, sparking widespread protests.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1951 — Korean War: Armistice negotiations begin at Kaesong.
- 420 — Having usurped the throne of Emperor Gong of Jin, Liu Yu proclaims himself Emperor of the Liu Song dynasty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2002 — The Massacre of the Innocents, a painting by Peter Paul Rubens, is sold at a Sotheby's auction for £49.5 million (US\$76.2 million) to Lord Thomson.

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1999 — In women's association football, the United States defeats China in a penalty shoot-out at the Rose Bowl near Los Angeles to win the final match of the 1999 FIFA Women's World Cup. Watched by 90,185 spectators, the final sets a new world record for attendance at a women's spor...

- 2011 — Amid widespread backlash to revelations of phone hacking, the British weekly tabloid newspaper News of the World publishes its final issue and shuts down after nearly 168 years in print.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 192 of the year, 173 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Benedict of Nursia; Christian Feast Day: Drostan; Christian Feast Day: Kjeld; Christian Feast Day: Marciana of Toledo. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1932 — Alex Hassilev, French-born American folk singer and musician (died 2024)
- 1956 — Sela Ward, American actress
- 1952 — Stephen Lang, American actor and playwright
- 1994 — Nina Nesbitt, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1970 — Justin Chambers, American actor
- 1966 — Ricky Warwick, Northern Irish musician
- 1963 — Dean Richards, English rugby player and coach
- 1960 — Caroline Quentin, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — France legislates for the independence of Dahomey (later Benin), Upper Volta (later Burkina Faso) and Niger.
- 1962 — Project Apollo: At a press conference, NASA announces lunar orbit rendezvous as the means to land astronauts on the Moon, and return them to Earth.
- 1950 — Pakistan joins the International Monetary Fund and the International Bank.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Yugoslav Wars: Srebrenica massacre begins, lasting until 22 July.
- 1962 — First transatlantic satellite television transmission.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)